



Mostly sunny 70/52 • Tomorrow: A brief shower 68/43 **B18**

Democracy Dies in Darkness

SATURDAY, NOVEMBER 8, 2025 • \$4

High court halts order to release SNAP aid

Emergency action pauses judge's decree as appeal continues on food lifeline

BY MARK BERMAN

Supreme Court Justice Ketanji Brown Jackson late Friday evening temporarily blocked a judge's order that had directed the Trump administration to release November food assistance benefits in full the same day.

Jackson paused, for now, lower-court rulings that the Trump administration has resisted amid a legal battle over whether federal officials would deliver the funds for a program that is a vital lifeline for millions of people who rely on it to afford groceries.

Earlier Friday, the Trump administration had said it was working to release the benefits to comply with a judge's order, suggesting that the money would indeed be disbursed. But the administration also asked the high court to halt that order, pushing to avoid releasing the funds as directed.

In her brief order, Jackson said she was granting an administrative stay and pausing the lower court's directives to allow an appeals court time to issue a ruling on the matter.

The developments came amid ongoing court fights over Supplemental Nutrition Assistance Program (SNAP) benefits, which have been in limbo during the federal government shutdown and with the Trump administration resisting using other money

SEE SNAP ON A7

On the margins: Four Americans try to cope without food aid. **A6**

DOJ probes Bowser trip but says she's not the focus

This article is by Perry Stein, Emily Davies, Salvador Rizzo, Meagan Flynn and Jenny Gathright

The U.S. attorney's office in Washington has been investigating a trip that D.C. Mayor Muriel E. Bowser and four aides took to Qatar in 2023, but the mayor is not a target, according to law enforcement and other administration officials.

"Mayor Bowser is not under investigation, nor is she the target of any investigation," U.S. Attorney Jeanine Pirro said in a statement Friday.

Bowser and four staff members traveled to Qatar in December 2023 for meetings on economic development. The trip was partially paid for by the Qatari government. Such payments for travel are legal but subject to restrictions.

The New York Times reported Thursday that Pirro's office had opened an investigation into Bowser and that the probe was looking into possible violations of bribery or campaign finance laws.

Also on Thursday, a person familiar with the matter, who spoke on the condition of anonymity for fear of retribution, told The Washington Post that the public corruption unit in the U.S. attorney's office had been examining Bowser and the Doha

SEE BOWSER ON A7



SIRACHAI ARUNRUGSTICHA/FOR THE WASHINGTON POST

Thai officials inspect a seized shipment of about 10 million methamphetamine tablets most likely manufactured in labs in Myanmar.

China's chemical exports are behind a 'tsunami' of meth swamping Asia

The shipment of chemicals from China was meant to stay near Bangkok. But a tracker, planted by Thai drug authorities based on a tip from the U.S. Drug Enforcement Administration, showed it moving north toward the porous 1,500-mile-long border with Myanmar.

Thai anti-narcotics officers believed the chemicals would be used to synthesize methamphetamine, a highly addictive stimulant flooding countries across the Asia-Pacific region. And they knew that on the other side of the border, in jungled hills ruled by China-backed warlords, was what the United Nations considered the biggest meth production hub in the world. The problem — which had paralyzed investigators repeatedly in the past, they

Precursor chemicals are shipped to warlords in Myanmar, fueling a drug crisis across the region, a Post investigation reveals

BY REBECCA TAN
IN MAE SAI, THAILAND

recounted — was that their mandate was to interdict illegal drugs, not the ingredients that could make them.

The tracker eventually blinked at a warehouse minutes from the crossing to Myanmar. At the Office of the Narcotics Control Board headquarters in Bangkok, leaders issued a command to the personnel on the border: Raid the warehouse.

A Washington Post investigation has found that Chinese manufacturers are shipping rapidly increasing amounts of chemicals that can be used in the production of synthetic drugs to lawless parts of Southeast Asia, where warlords and criminal gangs have been producing and trafficking record levels of meth.

This trade, which underpins a surging

SEE CHINA ON A10

Flight cancellations top 1,000 after FAA directive

BY LORI ARATANI, IAN DUNCAN, NATALIE B. COMPTON AND DANA MUNRO

Airlines canceled more than 1,000 flights Friday and hundreds more for Saturday at major airports across the United States as they scrambled to comply with a Trump administration order to reduce air traffic amid growing concerns about the impact potential staffing shortages could have on aviation safety.

Even so, the system appeared to be relatively resilient. As of Friday afternoon, roughly 94 percent of flights departed on time, according to Cirium, an aviation analytics firm — mirroring the system's performance over the past few weeks on average. The cancellation numbers were far below those seen during major weather events and IT outages that occurred in 2024, the firm said.

Still, there were some trouble spots. Staffing shortages at Rea-

gan National Airport forced the Federal Aviation Administration to slow arrivals Friday evening, resulting in more than 70 canceled flights and hours-long delays.

Transportation Secretary Sean P. Duffy warned that disruptions could worsen, with delays climbing as high as 20 percent if the federal government isn't reopened soon.

"If this shutdown doesn't end relatively soon, the consequence is that more controllers don't

come to work," he said in an appearance on Fox News.

Aviation analyst Henry Hartevelt also warned that the situation could worsen.

"This the calm before the storm," he said. "As bad as a 4 percent cut is, when you get to 10 percent, you are more than doubling the number of canceled flights."

The administration announced Wednesday that it would direct U.S. carriers to trim

SEE FLIGHTS ON A2

Sonic research has identified the cause of the racket, and tips for ignoring it

BY BISHOP SAND IN BRAINTREE, MASS.



Why is pickleball noise so annoying?

ALISA SHODIYEV KAFF AND JUSTIN SCUILETTI/THE WASHINGTON POST

THE ECONOMY

Tech companies are pouring so much money into AI that the astronomical numbers have lost all meaning. **A15**
The U.S. will not attend the COP30 climate conference amid the Trump administration's ongoing efforts to reject clean energy. **A15**

STYLE

Members of the punk band Husker Du talk about a newly released live recording of an electrifying 1985 show. **B1**

SPORTS

Virginia keeps on winning, and the U-Va. brain, conditioned with a sense of dread, struggles to comprehend. **B7**

THE REGION

A woman pleaded guilty to three counts in a crash that killed NFL rookie Khyree Jackson and two friends. **B13**

OBITUARIES

Paul R. Ignatius, who was Navy secretary in the Vietnam War and later a Washington Post executive, was 104. **B16**

BUSINESS NEWS.....	A15
COMICS.....	B4
OBITUARIES.....	B16
OPINION PAGES.....	A16
TELEVISION.....	B6
WORLD NEWS.....	A8

CONTENT © 2025
The Washington Post
Year 148, No. 54394



IN THE NEWS

Diplomatic heavyweight After helping broker the ceasefire in the Gaza war, Egypt seeks to reclaim its position as a major power player in the Middle East. **A8**

Labor Department posts In the agency's social media campaign, the face of the American workforce is a White man. **A4**

THE NATION

An Indiana woman was shot to death after arriving at the wrong address for cleaning. **A2**
A backlash to Donald Trump's policies led to a leftward shift among Latino voters. **A5**

THE WORLD

The E.U.'s defense chief is urging the U.S. to coordinate its troop draw-down with allies. **A13**
Dick Cheney has died, but his costly and deadly Iraq War legacy lives on, a columnist writes. **A13**